C20W11 · TUESDAY, APRIL 7, 2026

KNOW YOUR NUMBERS

Analytics setup, funnels, and what to measure.

USER COUNT LEADERBOARD

Week 3. Update your numbers.

Sift –	Vouch 1	QuestCity –	Rekindled –
Roam –	Circles –	FreeWeight –	Recruitr –
Misfit AI –	Evidence of Life –	NoticeMe –	Std. Deviants –

TEAM PRESENTATIONS

2 teams per class. ~10 min each (5 min present, 5 min feedback).

DATE	CLASS	TEAM 1	TEAM 2
Tue, Apr 7 (today)	c20		
Thu, Apr 9	c21	Circles	Evidence of Life
		QuestCity	
Tue, Apr 14	c22	FreeWeight	Vouch
		Rekindled	
Thu, Apr 16	c23	Std Deviants	Misfit AI
		Roam	
Tue, Apr 21	c24	NoticeMe	Sift
Thu, Apr 23	c25	Recruitr	

Format

Show the product live. Walk through your data. Where are you

Not Demo Day

Practice + feedback. Demo Day polish comes later.

API ENDPOINT CHECK-IN

This is a straightforward and quick feature. Get it launched.

Vouch — endpoint live, returning data ✔

Everyone else — not submitted yet

This is a 30-minute task. Get it done this week.

YOUR ANALYTICS SETUP

TWO TOOLS, TWO JOBS

GA4

How people **find** you

- Traffic sources (Google, Reddit, direct)
- Page views and session duration
- Geography and device type
- Bounce rate

Best for: **Acquisition**

Amplitude

What people **do** once they arrive

- Custom events (button clicks, feature usage)
- Funnel analysis (multi-step flows)
- User paths (what they actually do)
- Retention curves

Best for: **Activation + Retention**

GA4: THE THREE REPORTS THAT MATTER

1. Acquisition Overview

Where are people coming from? Organic search, direct, social, referral? **This tells you which growth channels are working.**

2. Engagement Overview

How long are people staying? What pages do they visit? Are they bouncing immediately or exploring?

3. Pages and Screens

Which pages get the most views? Where do people land, and where do they leave? **Your highest-exit page is your biggest leak.**

These are in GA4's left sidebar under Reports.

AMPLITUDE: THE THREE VIEWS THAT MATTER

1. Event Segmentation

How many times is each event firing? Which features are actually being used? **This is your product heartbeat.**

2. Funnel Analysis

Define a multi-step flow (signup > onboarding > first action). See where people drop off. **This is your diagnostic tool.**

3. User Paths

What do users actually do after signup? Not what you designed. What they *actually* do. Often surprising.

Event Segmentation and Funnel Analysis are in Amplitude's left sidebar. User Paths is under "Journeys."

WHAT TO TRACK

DEFAULTS AREN'T ENOUGH

GA4 auto-tracks:

- Page views
- Scroll depth
- Outbound clicks
- Site search
- Session start/end

Amplitude auto-tracks:

- Session start/end
- Page views (if configured)
- App open/close (mobile)
- Revenue events (if configured)

⚡ **The defaults tell you someone visited. They don't tell you what they did.** You need custom events.

CUSTOM EVENTS: MAP TO YOUR AARRR STAGES

STAGE	WHAT TO TRACK	EXAMPLE EVENTS
Acquisition	Landing page visits, signup starts	`page_view, signup_started`
Activation	Signup completed, onboarding steps, first value action	`signup_completed, onboarding_step_1, first_rating`
Retention	Return visits, repeat usage	`session_start (day 2+), second_rating`
Referral	Share actions, invite sends	`invite_sent, profile_shared`
Revenue	Purchase, subscription start	`purchase_completed, trial_started`

Start with **Acquisition** and **Activation** events. Those are the stages you're in right now.

START WITH 2 EVENTS, NOT 50

Amplitude's own documentation recommends starting with just two important events and expanding from there.

- Your **signup event** (Account Created)
- Your **core value action** (the thing that means "this user got it")

If nobody on your team can name your events from memory, you have too many.

NAME YOUR EVENTS CONSISTENTLY

Object + Action, Title Case (industry standard)

`Account Created`, `Outfit Generated`, `Event Bookmarked`

Properties use snake_case: `referral_source`, `plan_type`

Not this

`click_button_3`, `misc_event`, `test123`, `User Signed Up (2026-01-01)`

⚡ `Song Played` and `song played` are **two different events** in Amplitude. Casing matters.

YOUR PRODUCT HAS A CRITICAL PATH

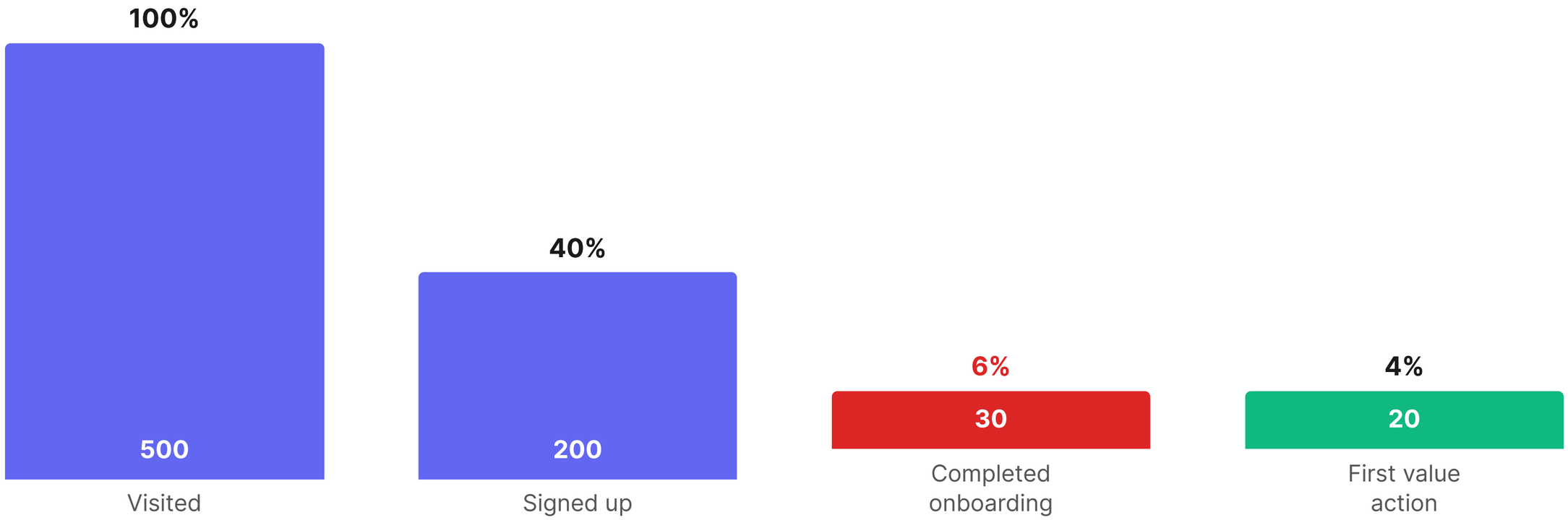
Every product has a sequence of steps a user must complete to get value.

Land on site → Sign up → Onboarding → First value action → Come back

Each arrow is where people drop off. **Your job is to find the biggest drop-off and fix it.**

HOW TO READ A FUNNEL

EXAMPLE: A FUNNEL WITH A PROBLEM



The problem is obvious. 200 signed up but only 30 completed onboarding. 85% drop-off. **Fix onboarding.**

EACH DROP-OFF TELLS YOU SOMETHING DIFFERENT

Visit → Signup Landing page isn't compelling, or you're driving the wrong traffic.

Signup → Onboarding Onboarding is too confusing, too long, or asking too much too soon.

Onboarding → Value People finish onboarding but don't do the thing. The aha moment isn't clear.

💡 **Different drop-offs = different fixes.** Don't guess. The funnel tells you exactly where to look.

ROUGH BENCHMARKS (FOR ORIENTATION, NOT TARGETS)

FUNNEL STEP	TYPICAL RANGE	SOURCE
Landing page → Signup	3-4% (B2B SaaS median)	Unbounce, 41K pages
Signup → Activation	25-36% (median to avg)	Lenny's Newsletter, 500+ products
Day-7 retention (top 25%)	7%	Amplitude Benchmark Report
Freemium → Paid	1-10%	OpenView / Userpilot

💡 With 30 users, these benchmarks are context, not targets. Your question is binary: **are users reaching the aha moment, or aren't they?**

USER TESTING AND ANALYTICS

You watched 3-5 people use your product last week.

You probably saw them:

- Get confused at a specific step
- Click on things that don't work
- Miss the feature you thought was obvious
- Give up before reaching the aha moment

These methods should reinforce each other. If you're seeing someone get confused, and you also see dropoff at that step of your funnel, then you know you've validated a problem in your product.

LEADING VS LAGGING INDICATORS

LAGGING INDICATORS: THE REARVIEW MIRROR

These tell you what already happened. Important, but you can't change them.

Churn rate	How many people stopped using you
Revenue	How much money came in
Total signups	Cumulative users over all time

By the time a lagging indicator moves, the cause happened weeks ago.

LEADING INDICATORS: THE WINDSHIELD

These predict what's *about to* happen. These are what you act on.

Activation rate	Predicts retention
Time to aha moment	Shorter = better
Onboarding completion rate	Predicts whether new users become real users
Daily signup rate	Predicts whether growth channels are working now
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	Predicts revenue and growth trajectory

THE RELATIONSHIP

Leading
Activation rate goes up

→

Lagging
Retention improves next month

Leading
Daily signups trending up

→

Lagging
Revenue grows next quarter

Improve the leading indicator *now*. The lagging indicator follows.

VANITY VS ACTIONABLE METRICS

VANITY METRICS FEEL GOOD

10,000 page views

But how many signed up? Did any come back?

500 total signups

Over what time period? How many are active?

2,000 app downloads

Downloads aren't users. 90% may never open the app.

ACTIONABLE METRICS HELP YOU DECIDE

15% activation rate

Action: simplify onboarding.

60% drop-off at step 2

Action: redesign that step.

3x more signups from Reddit than Instagram

Action: double down on Reddit.

IF THIS NUMBER CHANGED, WOULD I CHANGE WHAT I'M BUILDING?

If yes, it's actionable. If no, it's vanity.

QUICK EXERCISE: YOUR LEADING INDICATOR

2 minutes with your team:

1. Name your product's (the aha moment)
2. Name you should track this week
3. What's your current best guess for that number?

If you don't know the number, that's fine. That's why we're setting up analytics.

THE NORTH STAR METRIC

One behavioral metric that captures the core value your product delivers.

Slack: 2,000 messages sent

Stewart Butterfield: "Any team that has exchanged 2,000 messages in its history has tried Slack, really tried it." After 2,000 messages, 93% of teams stay.

Source: First Round Review interview

Facebook: 7 friends in 10 days

Chamath Palihapitiya: "The single biggest thing we realized." It became the company's singular focus at every all-hands.

Source: October 2012 talk

With 10-50 users, your NSM is a hypothesis. That's fine. It tells you what to look for in user testing.

ATTRIBUTION

KNOW WHERE YOUR USERS COME FROM

You're running multiple growth channels. Some will work. Most won't.

If you can't tell which channel drove each user, you can't decide where to spend time next week.

⚡ Without attribution, you're spending effort blindly. **With it, you double down on what works.**

UTM PARAMETERS: TAG YOUR LINKS

Add tracking parameters to every link you share. GA4 reads these automatically.

```
yourapp.com?utm_source=reddit
&utm_medium=organic
&utm_campaign=asknyc_post
```

utm_source
Where: reddit, instagram, email

utm_medium
How: organic, paid, dm

utm_campaign
Which: asknyc_post, week1_outreach

THE LOW-TECH BACKUP

Add one field to your signup flow:

How did you hear about us?

Friend | Reddit | Instagram | Search | Other

UTM parameters miss direct shares (texts, word of mouth). This catches those.

DON'T BUILD DASHBOARDS NOBODY CHECKS

Building impressive analytics dashboards that don't drive decisions is a common form of avoiding real contact with users.

- If review meetings end without action items, the dashboard isn't helping
- If you can't explain what you'd change based on a metric, remove it
- If you're spending more time on analytics than talking to users, stop

Analytics is a supporting actor at your stage, not the lead. The lead is still user conversations.

ASSIGNMENT: ANALYTICS SNAPSHOT

WHAT TO SUBMIT

1. Screenshots of your dashboards

GA4 Acquisition Overview + Amplitude Event Segmentation. Proof that it's installed and collecting data.

2. Your funnel with actual numbers

Define your critical path (3-5 steps). Show the conversion rate at each step. Even if the numbers are small.

3. Written analysis (1 page max)

Where's your biggest drop-off? What do you think is causing it? What will you do about it?

WHAT A GOOD ANALYSIS LOOKS LIKE

"We drove 45 visitors from Reddit and 12 from Instagram DMs. Of the 45 Reddit visitors, 18 signed up (40%). Of the 12 Instagram visitors, 2 signed up (17%). Reddit is clearly our stronger channel.
Of the 20 total signups, 8 completed onboarding (40%). The biggest drop-off is between account creation and completing their first [action] — 12 people created accounts but never finished setup.
Based on our user testing, the setup form is too long. We're cutting it from 5 fields to 2 this week."

Numbers + insight + action. That's the formula.

EVEN IF YOUR NUMBERS ARE SMALL

5 users is enough to learn from.

- 5 signups and 0 completed onboarding? Clear signal.
- 3 of 5 users from the same channel? Clear signal.
- Nobody clicks the button you thought was obvious? Clear signal.

Small data with clear patterns beats big data with no interpretation.

DUE: THURSDAY, APRIL 16

Submit as a PDF or markdown to your team folder in the class repo.

File name: `analytics_snapshot.md` or `analytics_snapshot.pdf`

That gives you a week and a half to collect data from your growth sprint and write the analysis.

NEW: WEEKLY UPDATE (EVERY TUESDAY)

Starting now, every team submits a short update to your team folder every week.

What to include:

1. **What we built last week** and why
2. **What we're building this week** and why
3. **Current user count**
4. **Biggest blocker** (if any)

File: `weekly_update_YYYY-MM-DD.md`

Length: Half a page. Not a novel.

WHAT'S NEXT

USER TESTING ROUND 2: DUE THURSDAY

3-5 users testing your onboarding flow.

- Recruit strangers, not teammates
- Watch them go from signup to your aha moment
- Note where they get confused, where they hesitate, where they give up
- This is the qualitative half of what we just taught — your analytics will show the same drop-offs at scale

If round 1 revealed problems, this round should test whether your fixes worked.

THIS WEEK

Due Thursday, April 9

User testing round 2 (3 sessions focused on onboarding)
Growth strategy doc + 20 users
API metrics endpoint
Weekly update (first one)

Every week (first one due Thursday, April 9)

Weekly Update: what you built, what you're building, user count, blockers

Due Thursday, April 16

Analytics Snapshot (screenshots + funnel + analysis)

THURSDAY: THE COLD START PROBLEM

How to launch a product that needs other people to be valuable.

- Why most social/network products die before they start
- Strategies that actually work at small scale
- What your team can do this week

FEATURE FREEZE: APRIL 23.

16 days. Everything after that is measurement and pitch prep.

KNOW YOUR NUMBERS

Set up the events. Read the funnel. Fix the biggest drop-off.